

10

Very High

9

8

High

7

6

5

4

Moderate

3

2

1

Low

airTEXT 
Air quality service

Promoting airTEXT

Introduction and purpose of this communications pack

This pack has been developed for local authority airTEXT consortium members to help them and their partner organisations in the NHS and voluntary sector to promote airTEXT — a free service that provides air pollution, pollen, UV and temperature alerts by text, email, or voice message.

airTEXT helps your local residents take simple steps to protect their health when air pollution is high. The service is especially valuable for people who may be more sensitive to pollution, including those with asthma, COPD, heart or lung conditions, or if pregnant, a child, or older adult.

A range of promotional materials are provided, along with ideas to increase sign-ups to airTEXT, help you raise awareness about air pollution, and support more people to reduce their exposure so they can breathe easier.

This pack has been developed by airTEXT in collaboration with Colchester City Council.



A note about adapting this pack to your area

Please feel free to adapt and brand these materials to suit your local area. You can replace the NHS, Essex Air, and Colchester City Council logos with your own, but the airTEXT logo should remain.

QR code

The QR code links to **www.airtext.info**, where people can sign up for free alerts and get tips to reduce their exposure on moderate and high pollution days. You can replace it with a QR code to your own website if you want to share additional local information.

Contents of this pack

This pack provides a range of ready-to-use content and ideas for different communication activities.

Page 4	Newsletter stories – Sample short articles for use in local newsletters, bulletins or websites.
Page 5	Social media posts – Sample copy for use on e.g. Facebook, Instagram, X, Blue Sky and LinkedIn.
Page 8	A4 poster – Poster for display in public spaces such as libraries, GP surgeries, or community centres.
Page 9	A6 postcard – Postcard to handout or mail insert for outreach and events.
Page 10	On screen advert – Text for online graphics or digital signage.
Page 11	FAQs – Simple answers for residents or partners about what airTEXT is and how it works.
Page 13	Implementation ideas – Practical ways local authorities, health organisations and community groups can raise awareness and increase sign-ups.

Print ready artwork for the poster and postcard is available at www.airtext.info.

Short version:

Take control of your exposure to bad air

When the air is polluted, it can make breathing more difficult and trigger health problems, especially if you have asthma, heart or lung conditions, or if you are pregnant, a child, or older adult.

airTEXT is a free service that sends alerts when air pollution levels are expected to reach moderate or high in your area. It also provides local three-day forecasts covering pollen, UV and temperature. This helps you take steps to limit your exposure on days with poorer air quality.

Sign up in just 30 seconds at **www.airtext.info** and join other local residents using airTEXT to take control and breathe easier.

Longer version:

Take control of your exposure to bad air

When the air is polluted, it can make breathing more difficult and trigger health problems, especially if you have asthma, heart or lung conditions, or if you are pregnant, a child, or older adult.

airTEXT is a free service that sends alerts when air pollution levels are expected to reach moderate or higher in your area. It also provides local three-day forecasts covering pollen, UV, temperature. This helps you take steps to limit your exposure on days with poorer air quality.

Simple steps include:

- Close windows facing traffic or main roads.
- When walking or cycling avoid busy roads and choose cleaner routes.
- Switch off your engine when parked or waiting.
- Reduce strenuous outdoor activities.
- If prescribed an inhaler, keep it with you and use as directed.

Sign up in just 30 seconds at **www.airtext.info** and join other local residents using airTEXT to take control and breathe easier.

Social media posts

Facebook/Instagram

Post 1

When air pollution is high, it can make breathing more difficult and trigger symptoms — especially if you have asthma, heart or lung conditions, or if you are pregnant, a child, or older adult.

With airTEXT, you'll get free alerts when pollution levels in your area are expected to reach moderate or high. You'll also receive 3-day forecasts for pollen, UV and temperature, helping you plan your day and reduce your exposure.

Sign up in just 30 seconds:
www.airtext.info

#TakeControl #airTEXT #BreatheEasier
#CleanAir

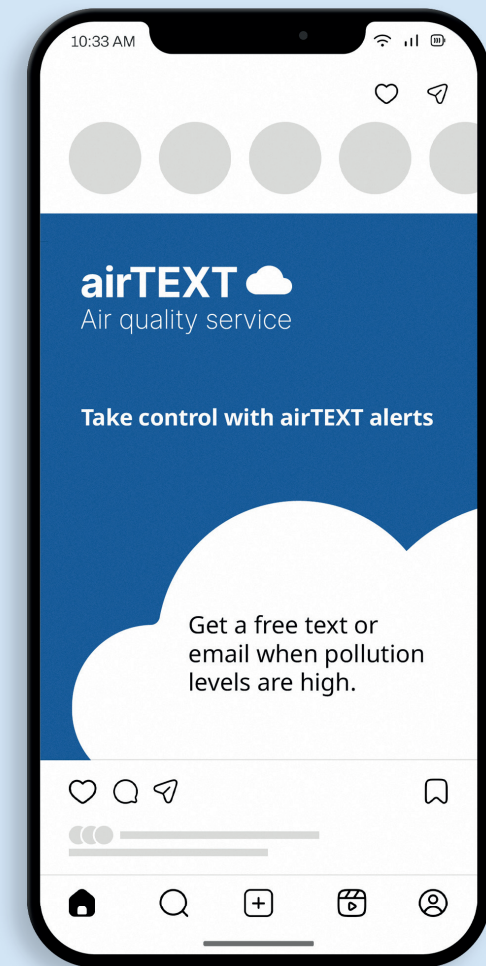
Post 2

Did you know that air pollution can worsen breathing problems and increase the risk of flare-ups and hospital visits?

airTEXT helps you plan ahead. You'll get free alerts when pollution levels rise in your area, so you know when to reduce your exposure by limiting your time near busy roads, or take other simple protective steps.

Join other local residents using airTEXT to take control and breathe easier:
www.airtext.info

#TakeControl #airTEXT #BreatheEasier
#CleanAir



Social media posts

X / Blue Sky

Post 1

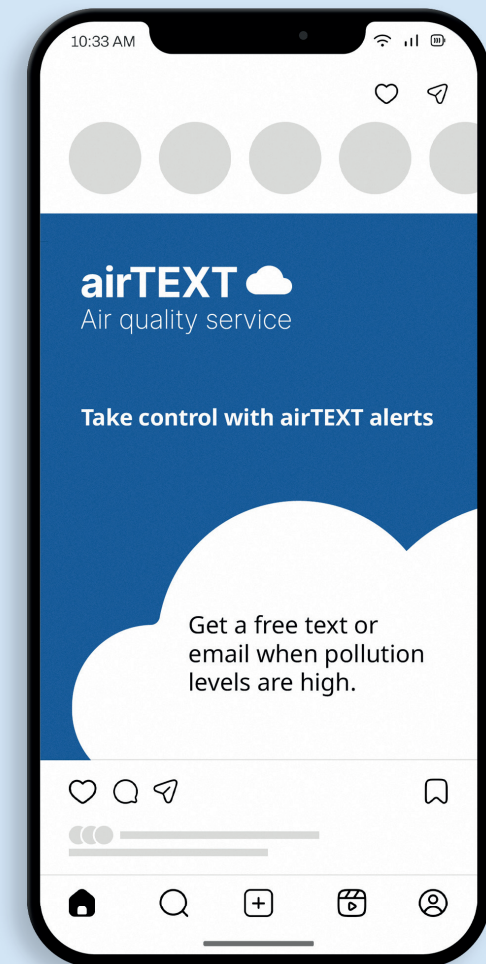
Air pollution can make breathing harder, especially if you have asthma or other lung or heart conditions. Get free air quality alerts for your area so you know when to limit your exposure: www.airtext.info

Post 2

Get free alerts when air pollution is moderate or high in your local area. Sign up to airTEXT in 30 seconds: www.airtext.info

Post 3

Want to reduce your exposure to bad air? Sign up for free airTEXT alerts for your local area and get simple tips on how to breathe easier: www.airtext.info



Social media posts

LinkedIn (for partners)

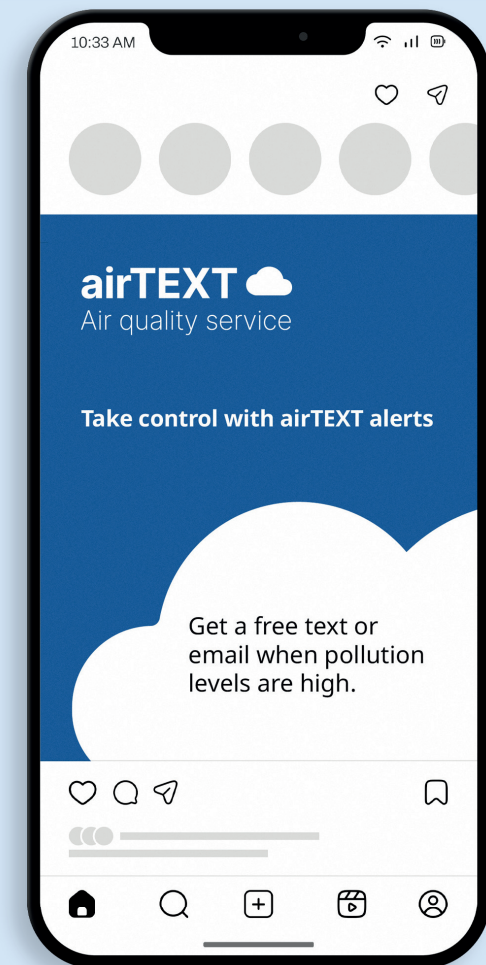
We're working with airTEXT, a free public-health alert service that helps residents plan ahead when air pollution, pollen, UV or temperature levels are high.

Forecasts are updated twice daily, and alerts are issued when levels reach moderate or high in a local area. This helps people take action to limit exposure to poor quality air. Simple steps include limiting time near busy roads and closing windows facing traffic.

Sign-up is easy and takes just 30 seconds.

Please join us in encouraging local residents to use airTEXT to take control of their exposure to bad air.

Learn more at www.airtext.info





airTEXT 
Air quality service

Take control with airTEXT alerts

Air pollution can make breathing harder, especially if you have a lung or heart condition, or if you are pregnant, a child, or older adult.



Get a free text or email when pollution levels are high.

 Visit **www.airtext.info** or scan the QR code to sign-up and get tips to reduce your exposure.



A6 postcard



Front



Back



The advertisement features a vertical air quality index scale on the left, ranging from 1 (Low, green) to 10 (Very High, dark grey). The scale is divided into four categories: Low (1-3), Moderate (4-6), High (7-9), and Very High (10). The main body of the ad has a dark blue background with the airTEXT logo and tagline at the top. Below this, the headline 'Take control with airTEXT alerts' is displayed in large white text. A white cloud graphic at the bottom contains the text: 'Get notified when air pollution levels are high in your area and take simple steps to reduce your exposure. Sign up at www.airtext.info.'

Index	Category
10	Very High
9	High
8	
7	
6	Moderate
5	
4	
3	Low
2	
1	

airTEXT 
Air quality service

Take control with airTEXT alerts

Get notified when air pollution levels are high in your area and take simple steps to reduce your exposure.

Sign up at www.airtext.info.

What is airTEXT?

A free alert service that provides forecasts for air quality, pollen, UV and temperature in your area.

Why does it matter?

When the air is polluted, it can make breathing more difficult and can trigger symptoms or worsen health conditions.

Who is it for?

Everyone, but especially people who may be more sensitive to pollution, including those with asthma, COPD, heart or lung conditions, or if pregnant, a child, or older adult.

How do I sign up?

Visit www.airtext.info, choose your area, and select whether to receive SMS, email or voice alerts.

How will I receive the alerts?

You can choose to receive the free air quality alerts by text message, email or voicemail.

When will I receive alerts?

Forecasts are updated twice daily (at 7am and 7pm). You'll get an alert when air pollution is forecast to reach moderate or high in at least 10% of your selected area.

What effect does air pollution have on health?

Air pollution is recognised as a contributing factor in the development of lung conditions, heart disease and cancer. There is also evidence highlighting possible links between air pollution and diabetes, dementia and underweight births.

Source: The Royal College of Physicians (RCP), 2025, A breath of fresh air: responding to the health challenges of modern air pollution.

How can I limit my exposure to outdoor air pollution at times when levels are high?

Here are some simple steps you can take:

- Close windows facing traffic or main roads.
- When walking or cycling avoid busy roads and choose cleaner routes.
- Switch off your engine when parked or waiting.
- Reduce strenuous outdoor activities.
- If prescribed an inhaler, keep it with you and use as directed.

Is there somewhere I can find out about cleaner routes I could choose to use?

Yes, if you live in London, Thurrock, Slough and Surrey you can visit cleanairroutes.org. This uses airTEXT data to provide details of walking and cycling routes with the best local air quality. It is expected that more areas will be covered in the future.

Is there any advice on what I can do to improve the air I breathe inside my home?

As air pollution inside can sometimes be worse than the air outdoors, it can help to keep your home warm, dry and well ventilated, especially when cooking, cleaning, showering or drying clothes. It is also recommended you try to avoid burning wood, candles or incense and cut down on use of aerosols, sprays, air fresheners and other scented products.

This section provides practical ideas for how councils, NHS organisations, voluntary sector, schools, and community groups can raise the profile of airTEXT and increase sign-ups. These approaches build on the tools provided in this communications pack with additional ways to engage your local residents.

1. Digital channels — Make sign-up easy and visible

- Add a homepage banner or tile on Council and NHS websites linking to www.airtext.info.
- Include airTEXT information in e-newsletters to residents, parents or patient networks.
- Use monthly social media posts (based on the templates provided), timed with air quality or weather events.
- Incorporate small banner text into existing council tax, waste or parking emails.
- Add push notifications or tiles in local resident apps.
- Consider small paid promotions to reach target postcodes on social media.

2. Community outreach — Reach people where they are

- Display A4 posters or A6 postcards in libraries, GP surgeries, pharmacies, social housing and community centres.
- Use the digital banner on publicly available TV screens or electronic noticeboards.
- Encourage parish councils and community groups to share information through WhatsApp or Facebook groups, including Neighbourhood Watch groups.
- Include airTEXT information at local events, fairs and markets with staff or volunteers available to help residents sign up via QR code.
- Promote airTEXT through schools and parent networks.
- Incorporate airTEXT into school eco-club activities or science lessons about the environment and health.
- Partner with local radio presenters or community influencers to mention airTEXT in weather or health segments.

3. Health partnerships — Link to health and wellbeing

- Ask GPs, asthma clinics, and respiratory nurses to include airTEXT flyers or QR codes in care packs.
- Add sign-up information onto GP and practice websites as a recommendation for action by people with asthma or heart conditions.
- Link airTEXT promotion to national health and environment campaigns such as Clean Air Day, Asthma Awareness Week or Heatwave Alerts.
- Undertake outreach work direct to Patient Participation Groups via GP surgeries and health-based voluntary sector organisations.

4. Environmental and climate change integration

- Include airTEXT within active travel, clean air and climate engagement programmes
- Share local air quality monitoring data alongside airTEXT forecast information and updates about progress with local air quality action plans.
- Run local 'Sign up for airTEXT' challenges or awareness weeks to boost registrations.

- Feature airTEXT in themed or seasonal environmental activity, such as during winter home burning campaigns, Clean Air Day and anti-idling campaigns.

5. Local authority visibility and leadership

- Feature airTEXT in council press releases and include quotes from Cabinet Members or Directors of Public Health.
- Encourage all council and NHS staff to sign up, creating internal ambassadors.
- Add airTEXT information to internal newsletters, intranets, and staff communications.
- Use Council owned digital signage, bus shelters, or billboards to display short airTEXT messages.
- Add QR codes to printed materials such as parking tickets, library cards, Council tax statements, or other Council flyers.
- Include airTEXT in standard council templates such as email signatures and letterheads.
- Run an internal airTEXT Challenge Week across departments to encourage sign-ups.